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Xiaomi eyes India rebuild in 2026

More resources, broader portfolio, and lots more incoming

Manas Tiwari | editor@digit.in

After a difficult year, Xiaomi aims for a major rebuild in India on the back of bigger investments, expanded product portfolio and a renewed focus on certain categories, the company's top executives told me. While the company will continue to bet big on smartphones, it believes that a tightly integrated ecosystem will drive its next phase of growth in the country.

"We are very excited about our future in India. It was very important to us for our global debut," said Adam Zeng, Senior Vice President, Xiaomi Group and President of its International Business Department as he gave a broad outlook of the company's priorities going into next year. Adam, on his maiden visit to India, promised that the country remains a high-priority market for the company.

Alvin Tse, Vice President, Xiaomi Global said that Zeng has committed more resources for the India unit this year as they look to deepen its mid-premium smartphone portfolio. He didn't give exact details about these resources, it could mean investments from the company and a higher manpower allocation.

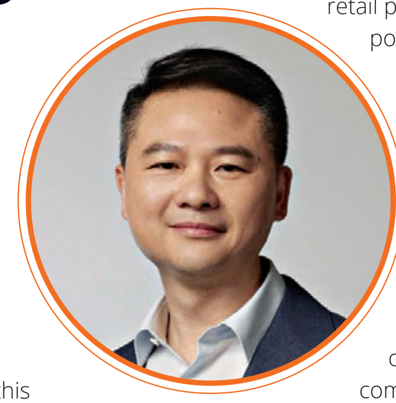
Sudhin Mathur
Chief Operating Officer of Xiaomi India

Alvin confirmed that Xiaomi is considering expanding its product portfolio in India and during this trip, Adam will assess how many of the company's current 200+ product categories from China can be introduced here.

"Mr. Adam also brought AIoT go-to-market (GTM) leadership from headquarters to understand which of our 200+ product categories in China can be brought here either through imports in the short term or localisation in the mid to long term," Alvin had said.

He agreed that the company has faced difficult times these past few years but a change in strategy will allow the brand to revive itself. When asked about the current components crisis and increasing prices of smartphones, Alvin said that Xiaomi is better prepared than its rivals and has the endurance to absorb these hikes.

Not too long ago, Xiaomi was the number 1 smartphone brand in India — a position it retained for several years before changing market dynamics and consumer needs allowed Vivo and Oppo to take over the top spots. Since then, Xiaomi has faced several challenges including leadership changes, differences with retail partners and product portfolio criticism.



Adam Zeng
Senior Vice President, Xiaomi Group and President of its International Business Department

Sudhin Mathur, Chief Operating Officer of Xiaomi India, indicated that Xiaomi is setting the stage for a decisive reset. He described 2026 as a landmark year, one that will see the company roll out a more structured and clearly laddered smartphone portfolio, spanning from the Rs 7,000 segment to flagship offerings.

Beyond smartphones, tablets and wearables are set to receive meaningful upgrades in display quality and performance, reflecting evolving usage patterns. Xiaomi also plans to deepen its presence in home categories such as vacuum cleaners and air purifiers, with several of these expected to be localised in India as part of the company's broader manufacturing push.

"We reviewed our strategy, realigned our approach, and strengthened our omnichannel presence. We regained our number three position in smartphones and tablets and our wearables performed very well. We are now number one in that category," Mathur said, while adding that the company's QLED large-screen TVs have been received exceptionally well.

Xiaomi leads the power bank segment, has recorded 20% year growth in wearables, and delivered a sixfold growth in its QLED TV business. Non-phone categories account for 15% of Xiaomi's India revenue, highlighting the importance of its ecosystem play. d